

CogniSphere Technologies

Employee Policy Handbook | Effective: January 2026 | Internal Use Only

1. Company Overview

CogniSphere Technologies is a fictional software and IT consulting company created for training and demonstration purposes. CogniSphere provides services in enterprise software development, cloud consulting, and data analytics. This handbook outlines key workplace policies applicable to all employees across departments.

2. Working Hours & Attendance

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Employees are expected to log a minimum of 8 productive hours per day. Flexible start times between 9:00 AM and 10:00 AM are permitted with prior approval from the reporting manager. Any absence must be reported through the internal HR portal at least 2 hours before shift start, except in emergencies.

3. Leave Policy

All full-time employees are entitled to 24 paid leave days per calendar year, inclusive of casual and sick leave. Leave requests must be submitted at least 3 working days in advance via the HR portal, except for medical emergencies. Unused leave up to 5 days may be carried forward to the next year. Maternity leave is granted for 26 weeks and paternity leave for 2 weeks, in line with applicable labor law.

Leave Type	Days/Year	Carry Forward
Casual/Sick Leave	12	No
Earned/Privilege Leave	12	Up to 5 days
Maternity Leave	182 days (26 wks)	N/A
Paternity Leave	14 days	N/A

4. Remote & Hybrid Work Policy

CogniSphere follows a hybrid work model. Employees are required to work from office premises at least 3 days per week (Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday), with Monday and Friday available as optional work-from-home days, subject to manager approval. Fully remote arrangements may be granted on a case-by-case basis for specific roles or circumstances, approved by the department head and HR.

5. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to maintain professionalism, honesty, and respect in all workplace interactions. Harassment, discrimination, or any form of workplace misconduct will not be tolerated and may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination. Conflicts of interest, including outside employment that competes with CogniSphere's business, must be disclosed to HR in writing.

6. IT & Data Security Policy

All company-issued devices must have disk encryption and endpoint protection software enabled at all times. Employees must not share login credentials, API keys, or client data outside approved company systems. Use of personal cloud storage (e.g., personal Google Drive, Dropbox) for storing company or client data is strictly prohibited. Any suspected security incident must be reported to the IT Security team within 1 hour of discovery.

7. Expense Reimbursement

Business-related expenses (travel, client meetings, approved software subscriptions) are reimbursable with valid receipts submitted via the Finance portal within 15 days of the expense. Reimbursements are processed within 10 working days of approval. Expenses above \$500 require pre-approval from the reporting manager before being incurred.

8. Performance Reviews

Formal performance reviews are conducted twice a year, in June and December. Reviews are based on goal completion, peer feedback, and manager assessment. Employees are encouraged to maintain a running log of key achievements throughout the review cycle to support self-assessment.

9. Grievance Redressal

Employees with workplace concerns may raise a grievance through the HR portal or directly with the HR Business Partner assigned to their department. All grievances are acknowledged within 2 working days and investigated confidentially. Retaliation against an employee for raising a grievance in good faith is strictly prohibited.

Note: CogniSphere Technologies is a fictional entity. This document was generated for software development, testing, and educational purposes only (e.g., RAG pipeline testing) and does not represent any real company's actual policies.